

# Talha SANDHU

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## EDUCATION

### INSEAD

#### MBA

Fontainebleau, France

2025-2026

- Winner, IESE Roland Berger International Case Competition 2026, President of the Horse Riding Club

### University of Sussex

#### BSc International Business with Honours

Brighton, United Kingdom

2019-2021

- First Class Honours (GPA 4.0), Elected International Student Officer representing 5,500+ students

## EXPERIENCE

### QNB Capital

Doha, Qatar

*Investment banking arm of QNB Group, the largest bank in the Middle East and Africa by assets (~\$350bn)*

#### Investment Banking Analyst

2023-2025

- Led a 3-person analyst team across mandates spanning fintech, aviation, oil and gas, utilities, and construction, delivering client-ready analysis and recommendations directly to C-Suite and board-level stakeholders
- Shaped the analytical and strategic case for Qatar Investment Authority's \$770M takeover of Qatar Cool, presenting to QIA's C-Suite and independently identifying carbon-credit monetisation as an untapped revenue stream, which the CEO adopted as a core pillar of the client's sustainability positioning and IPO roadmap
- Constructed a sum-of-the-parts valuation across 10 subsidiaries to assess IPO feasibility for a \$570M fit-out group; identified that the client's liquidity timeline made a public listing unviable and pivoted to a private sale, raising ~\$150M in growth capital for the founders
- Deployed as part of an emergency advisory team on Qatar's largest construction sector crisis; structured a debt resolution for a firm with >\$1B in liabilities, personally managing stakeholder negotiations with bank CEOs, company founders, and government ministers and presenting to steering committee conferences throughout

### Cepheid Seed Company Pvt. Ltd

Islamabad, Pakistan

*Vertically integrated agribusiness specialising in high-quality, disease-resistant seed production and commercial farming*

#### Founder

2022-2023

- Founded and built Cepheid into a vertically integrated seed business on a 900-acre farm; secured financing, sourced machinery, and stood up operations from zero while managing a team of 50 across labourers, agronomists, contractors, and researchers, growing revenue 40% within the first year
- Identified operational losses across 900 acres through hands-on yield tracking and financial analysis; led the transition to solar energy and introduction of drip irrigation, managing each from vendor sourcing and contract negotiation through to installation, reducing energy costs by ~30% and water consumption by ~40%
- Identified a certified seed grading market gap through primary research; secured blended financing by negotiating term sheets and building the feasibility model independently; established a grading facility serving internal and external farmers and repositioned the portfolio toward higher-value varieties including G1 garlic and high-yield seeds

### MCR Property Group

London, United Kingdom

*Privately held real estate investment firm with £5bn+ of completed projects across the UK*

#### Acquisitions Analyst

2021-2022

- Originated a £23M off-market warehouse acquisition through cold outreach, independently valuing the asset and negotiating directly with the business owner through to close; the only analyst to source and close a deal independently that year
- Built IRR and DCF models across £400M+ of residential, logistics, and mixed-use opportunities, presenting return frameworks and recommendations to the CEO and investment committee on a weekly basis to drive capital allocation decisions
- Maintained a live deal pipeline across South England through daily outreach to agents, brokers, and developers, cold-approached businesses with logistics assets directly, and benchmarked 20+ sites to identify high-return warehousing and residential opportunities
- Identified underperforming assets across the portfolio by analysing cashflow yields, land utilisation, and refurbishment potential; developed value-add strategies that re-prioritised £60M+ of capital toward higher-return opportunities and presented recommendations directly to senior management

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

**Interests:** Polo player and horse rider; squash player in local leagues; mountaineering in the Himalayas and Karakoram at 4,000m; target and skeet shooting

**Language Proficiencies:** English, Urdu

**Technical Competencies:** Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Microsoft Office, Excel, PowerPoint, Tableau, DCF, M&A and LBO Modelling, Python